SOUTH LAKE HOME EDUCATORS



Lesson 1

Welcome, Internet Safety & Choosing Your Platform

Thursday, August 13, 2026

At a Glance

Lesson 1 objectives & materials

By the end of today, students will:

- Understand class structure and expectations
- Identify at least 2 online-safety practices specific to gaming
- Name the major disciplines of game development
- Have chosen (or shortlisted) an engine and made install progress

What We're Using Today

- Demo laptop with all 8 engines pre-installed + Key Press Reactor loaded
- NetSmartz video clip(s), queued and tested
- Engine & Platform Guide + Engine Showcase (sent home in advance)
- Sign-in sheet
- Offline installer backups on USB (in case of wifi trouble)

IGDA framework tie-in: Course/discipline orientation (Production & Critical Studies) and first exposure to the Programming content area.

Today's Agenda



0:00 - 0:10	Welcome, roll call, course overview
0:10 - 0:30	Internet Safety & Digital Citizenship (NetSmartz)
0:30 - 0:45	What Is Game Development?
0:45 - 1:00	Live Engine Tour: Key Press Reactor across all 8 engines
LAB TIME	***— Install & Setup —***
1:00 - 1:45	Guided install/setup of chosen engine, by station
1:45 - 1:52	Exit check: confirm working environment, quick share-out
1:52 - 2:00	This Semester's Game: reveal, GDD hand-out, codename vote



Welcome & Course Overview

Who we are, how the class runs, and what the whole year looks like.

10 min

Welcome & Course Overview

10 min

This class is:

- Hands-on and project-based — you'll be building the whole year
- Yours to choose: pick your own engine, and you can switch later
- Consistent across engines: every lesson provides examples for all 8 supported engines



Syllabus Highlights

Meeting schedule

30 lessons across two semesters, weekly, 2 hours each (lecture + lab)

Two capstones

Semester 1: a finished mini-game (find out exactly what today!).
Semester 2: your own game at the Co-op Expo

Policies

BYOD, AI-assistance guidelines, and conduct expectations — covered in the full Syllabus



Internet Safety & Digital Citizenship

Grounded in NetSmartz, with a gaming-specific lens — you'll be building and sharing games with each other all year.

20 min

Internet Safety & Digital Citizenship

20 min

Suggested NetSmartz materials (preview clips ahead of time; check missingkids.org/netsmartz for the current library):

“Attitude Overdrive”

NSTeens

Good fit for middle schoolers — appropriate conduct & etiquette while gaming online.

“Into the Cloud” — Season 2

Good fit for a mixed middle/high room

Livestreaming safety, reporting/removing inappropriate content, cyberbullying, seeking help from a trusted adult.

Real-Life Stories series

For older teens, use selectively

Examines peer choices online and real consequences.

Discussion Points



Chatting with strangers in multiplayer/voice chat — what's okay to share, what isn't

Recognizing griefing, cyberbullying, and manipulation in gaming communities — how and when to report or block

In-game purchases, scams, and “too good to be true” offers

No personal info in usernames, credits, or shared builds — once we start sharing games with each other this year

Who to go to if something online feels wrong: a parent, or the instructor



What Is Game Development?

A fast overview of the disciplines that make a game — so you can see where coding fits into the bigger picture.

15 min

The Five Disciplines

This class focuses on Programming, with light Design.



Design

Deciding what the game is and how it plays



Programming

Making the rules and mechanics actually work

MAIN FOCUS



Visual Art

Characters, environments, and UI



Audio

Music and sound effects



Production

Planning, scoping, and finishing a project



Live Engine Tour

One consistent demo — Key Press Reactor — run live across all 8 supported engines.

15 min

Live Engine Tour: Key Press Reactor

Press Play, tap an arrow key, watch the same reaction happen 8 different ways — about 60-90 seconds per engine.

Scratch Block	**GDevelop** Visual	**001 Game Creator** Visual	**GameMaker** Hybrid (Visual ↔ Script)
Unity Script (+ Visual option)	**Godot** Script	**TIC-80** Script	**Unreal (advanced track)** Hybrid (Blueprints ↔ C++)

Closing note: device-fit guidance so students with older laptops feel set up for success, not steered toward something that will frustrate them.



Lab Time: Install & Setup

Goal: every student leaves with a working environment for their chosen engine.

60 min

Lab: Install & Setup

Goal: every student leaves with a working environment — or at minimum, a browser-based fallback (GDevelop or Scratch) open and ready.

1. Quick poll: which engine is each student planning to start with?
2. Students who installed at home verify their install works and open a new project
3. Students who haven't installed: start with GDevelop or Scratch in-browser immediately, then queue a larger download in the background
4. Instructor circulates by station (clustered by chosen engine) to troubleshoot and answer questions
5. Exit check: each student's editor is open, ideally with a blank or template project loaded



This Semester's Game

The big reveal: what we're all building together this semester.

8 min

This Semester's Game

8 min

A top-down arcade shooter, in the tradition of classics like Space Invaders and Galaga. Move, dodge, and shoot your way through waves of descending enemies.

1

High Concept reveal

Everyone in class builds this same game this semester. Your code and your personal touches make it yours.

2

Hand out your GDD

Your Lesson 1 Game Design Document (sneak peek). Yours to keep.

3

Vote on a codename

Real studios use a codename before the final title is locked in. Let's pick ours!

Homework / Before Next Class



1

Finish your install

If your chosen engine wasn't fully installed by the end of lab, finish that at home.

2

Bookmark a tutorial

Skim the Student Resource List for your engine and bookmark one beginner tutorial.

3

Explore (optional)

Spend 15-20 minutes just clicking around your engine's interface to get comfortable.



See You Next Week!

Lesson 2: Key Press Reactor — build it yourself, in your chosen engine.

Questions before then? Reach out to your instructor.